

Jacobin

A member of the extreme revolutionary group during the French Revolution.

Jacobite

In British history, a supporter of the claims of the Stuart monarchs to regain the throne, after James II (Jacobus in Latin) was forced to flee and abdicate the British throne in 1689.

Jesuit

A member of the Society of Jesus, an organization founded in 1534 within the *Catholic Church*, which played a leading role in the *Counter-Reformation*. It continues to be active in education and in the spreading of Catholic doctrine.

jihad

A struggle or war undertaken on behalf of the Islamic faith (see *Islam*).

judiciary

A collective term for the judges holding office in a particular country.

khedive

A title used mainly by the rulers of Egypt from 1867 to 1914, who were nominally subject to the authority of the Ottoman (Turkish) Empire, but in practice were largely independent.

knight

A feudal rank (see *feudalism*) that combined a high status in society with obligations to undertake military service.

league

An association between individuals or states for mutual protection, or for furthering common interests.

legion

A fighting unit of the Roman army consisting of 3,000–6,000 men.

legislature

The institution(s) of government that are responsible for passing laws.

Levant

The region of the eastern Mediterranean and the territories bordering it.

liberalism

A political movement or philosophy that emphasizes individual freedom, as well as supporting forms of government that are answerable to the people (contrast *absolutism*). The term **economic liberalism** means support for free-market *capitalism*. In the US, **liberal** often implies a left-wing stance that supports increased governmental intervention and spending on social welfare.

mandate

A legal command or commission, especially a commission in which a country was authorized by the former League of Nations to govern a particular territory in the interests of its inhabitants. See also *trusteeship*.

manifesto

A written declaration of policy and goals, especially one issued by a political party or movement.

Marxist

Term applied to a variety of doctrines that trace their origin to the German-born philosopher and social thinker Karl Marx. Marx himself believed that he had discovered laws of history that proved that eventually *capitalism* would collapse and be replaced by *communism*.

Medieval period

The period from approximately 600 to 1450 CE in Europe, from the end of the western Roman Empire to the *Renaissance*.

mercenary

A soldier who fights for other nations for money.

missionary

A representative of a particular religion who travels to another country, region, or culture with the goal of converting people to his or her religion.

Monophysitism

The belief that Jesus Christ has only one nature (with his divine nature absorbing his human nature), rather than having two separate natures. A minority view in the Christian Church, it is upheld mainly by the Coptic Church and other churches with their roots in the ancient Near East.

multilateral

Involving three or more governments (or other organizations), especially with reference to treaties and agreements. Compare *bilateral*.

nation

(1) An independent country. (2) A people defined by shared historical, cultural, and linguistic ties, whether constituting a single independent country or not.

nationalism

A political attitude of strong support for the interests and future of one's nation.

nationalization

The taking of private property into public ownership by the state, especially on a large scale, such as an entire industry.

NATO

North Atlantic Treaty Organization, an international military alliance of Western powers established in 1949.

Nazism

The doctrines of the National Socialist (Nazi) party, in power in Germany under Adolf Hitler 1933–45. Nazism was similar to *fascism*, but in addition was racist, believing in the supremacy of a supposed “Aryan” race of which the German people were allegedly the “purest” representatives. See also *totalitarianism*.

neoclassicism

Any cultural movement in which styles or ideals of a *classical* period are revived. More specifically, an 18th-century movement in European art and literature that was inspired by renewed interest in the values of ancient Greek and Roman art.

neocolonialism

The situation in which a powerful, developed country has influence over a less developed country (especially a former colony) in ways that are seen as similar to aspects of actual *colonialism*.

oligarchy

A political system where a few powerful, and often rich, individuals combine to rule a country. The former Republic of Venice is a historic example. Many former communist countries (see *communism*) were also effectively oligarchies, with communist party officials monopolizing power.

order (religious)

In the Christian Church, a body of people adhering to a particular rule or way of life that is often set down by an individual founder—orders of monks, for example. The phrase “**in orders**” means occupying a clerical position, such as priest or bishop.

Orthodox Church

A major group of Christian Churches that descend from a split with the Western (*Catholic*) Church that occurred in 1054 CE. Prominent in Eastern and southeastern Europe, it includes several different traditions and national Churches.

Outremer

The *Medieval* French states set up in the Near East after the *Crusades*.

overlord

A lord who is superior to other lords or rulers, especially within the feudal system (see *feudalism*).

pacifism

Opposition to all war.

papal bull

An order or edict issued by a pope on a matter of importance.

peasant

A worker on the land, especially an agricultural laborer or small farmer.

pharaoh

Title of the ruler of ancient Egypt, who was traditionally seen as both a king and a god.

pilgrimage

A journey undertaken for religious reasons to a shrine or other sacred site.

plebiscite

A referendum, especially on a major constitutional issue.

pogrom

An organized massacre, especially one carried out against the Jews in Eastern Europe in the late 19th and early 20th centuries.

polity

A form of government and political organization.

populist

Generally a critical term for a politician whose power base comes from successfully appealing to the general public, without necessarily being respected by other politicians. It is often implied that a populist simply tells people what they want to hear.

Praetorian prefect

A high administrative office in the Roman Republic and Empire, deriving originally from the headship of the state bodyguards—the Praetorian Guard.

pre-Colombian

Relating to the cultures of the Americas before their contact with European explorers and conquerors.

Presbyterians

Members of various *Protestant* Churches that do not have a hierarchy of bishops, but are run by **presbyters** (elders) elected by church congregations.

proletariat

A collective term for working-class wage earners who do not possess their own capital (see *capitalism*); often contrasted with *bourgeoisie* (see *bourgeois*) in *Marxist* theory.

protectionism

The policy of defending the industries of a country by creating barriers to foreign competition, for example, restricting imports.

protectorate

A colony in which the emphasis is on the colonizing power being responsible for defense and foreign affairs for the benefit of the people of the territory.

Protestantism

Any of the forms of Christianity resulting from the *Reformation* of the 16th century and afterward, in which allegiance is no longer offered to the pope in Rome.

puppet state

A country that, though nominally independent, is actually under the control of another country.

purge

A term, usually associated with totalitarian systems (see *totalitarianism*), for the expulsion of people from an organization who are regarded as undesirable by the organization's leadership.

Puritanism

Originally a movement within the Church of England in the 16th and 17th centuries that pressed for further changes to Church organization and doctrine, going beyond the split from the *Catholic Church* that had occurred under Henry VIII. The term was later applied to religious groups with similar views outside the Church of England, and then eventually to any way of thinking that was seen as disapproving of pleasure and indulgence.